



Mandrill

Mandrillus sphinx

Mandrills live in large groups in tropical forest and forest-savanna mosaic habitats. They spend time on the ground and in trees where they feed mainly on fruit and insects, but will also eat small vertebrates. Groups number several hundred and even more than a thousand adult females and their young. Adult males may be solitary except during the mating season.

Size and color

Mandrills exhibit marked differences between the sexes: in addition to their colorful faces and yellow beards, the genital region and rump of the dominant males are a kaleidoscope of blue, red, pink, and purple. The dominant males are also roughly twice the size of the females, which are plain in comparison. When the females are ready to mate, the skin around their genitalia becomes swollen and red.

↔ 2–4 ft (55–110 cm)
⚖ 24–73 lb (11–33 kg)
⊗ Vulnerable
🌿 Fruit, eggs, small animals
🏠

W. Central Africa

thick,
olive-gray fur



▷ A FACE TO REMEMBER

Dominant male mandrills are the most colorful monkeys in the world. Their striking faces have a red stripe down the nose with blue ridges on either side. The long canine teeth may be displayed.

↔ 4–6 ft (1.3–1.7 m)
⚖ 125–420 lb (57–190 kg)
⊗ Critically endangered
🌿 Fruit, leaves, seeds, termites
🏠

C. Africa

Western gorillas feed on the fruit of more than 100 plant species